

Algebraic Topology: a beginner's course

This lecture:

**AlgTopReview2: Introduction
to group theory**

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Introduction to Group theory (review)



Introduction to Group theory (review)

	Commutative Gps	Non Comm. Gps.
Finite		
Infinite		

3) Identity There is a special element $e \in G$ such that $e * a = a * e = a$ for any $a \in G$

4) Inverse For every $a \in G$ there is a $b \in G$ such that $a * b = b * a = e$

We say b is the inverse of a $b = a^{-1}$

Ex $G = \{0, 1, 2, 3, 4\}$ $-4 = 1$

$+ = x$	0	1	2	3	4
0	0	1	2	3	4
1	1	2	3	4	0
2	2	3	4	0	1
3	3	4	0	1	2
4	4	0	1	2	3

$a * b \equiv a + b \pmod{5}$
 $1 * 3$
 $2 * 3$
 $3 * 1$
 $a \pmod{5}$
 remainder
 divided
 $13 \pmod{5}$
 $-4 \pmod{5}$

$$(2+3) \cdot 4 = 0 + 4 = 4$$

$$2 + (3+4) = 2 + 2 = 4$$

Convention. write $*$ as $+$ (for comm. gps only!)

In general $\mathbb{Z}_n$ for $n=1, 2, 3, \dots$

$$\mathbb{Z}_n = \{0, 1, \dots, n-1\}$$

$+$ = addition (mod n)

Ex. 2

$+$	0	1	2
0	0	1	2
1	1	2	0
2	2	0	1

$$G = \{0, 1, 2\} = \mathbb{Z}_3$$

Prev. ex. $\mathbb{Z}_5$

operation. write $*$ as $+$ (for comm. gps only!)

In general $\mathbb{Z}_n$ for $n=1, 2, 3, \dots$

$$\begin{array}{c|cc} & 1 & 2 \\ \hline 0 & 1 & 2 \\ 1 & 2 & 0 \\ 2 & 0 & 1 \end{array}$$

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$$\mathbb{Z}_n = \{0, 1, \dots, n-1\}$$

$+$ = addition (mod n)

Ex 3 $G = \mathbb{Z}$ operation $+$

Identity = 0

$$5 + (-5) = 0$$

Inverse of a is $-a$

Multiples $a \in \mathbb{Z}$ $a + a \equiv 2a$ $a + a + a \equiv 3a$ etc

λ operation + identity = 0

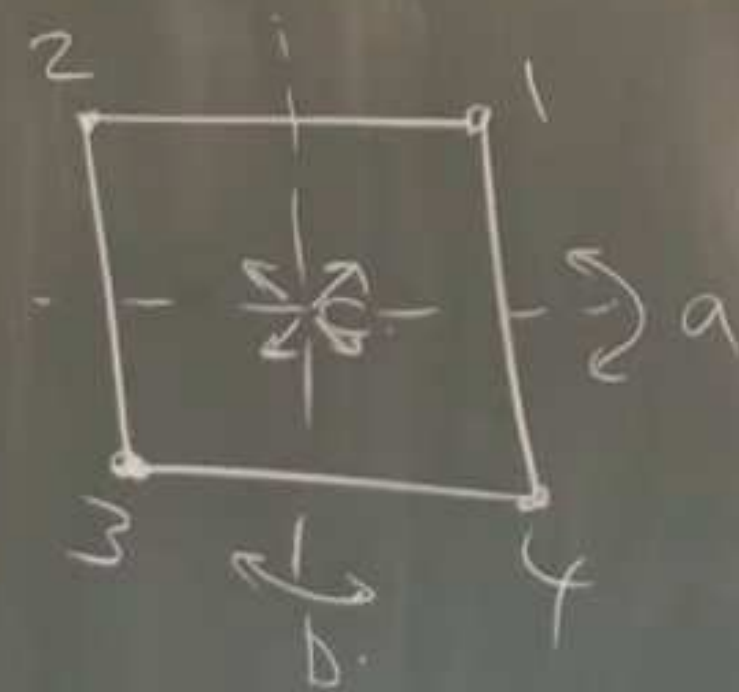
inverse $a = -a$

multiplicative notation)

x	1	a	b	c
1	1	a	b	c
a	a	1	c	b
b	b	c	1	a
c	c	b	a	1

group

$G = \{1, a, b, c\}$



a. $1 \leftrightarrow 4$
 $2 \leftrightarrow 3$

$(14)(23)$

$\ast =$ composition of transformations

b. $1 \leftrightarrow 2$
 $3 \leftrightarrow 4$

$(12)(34)$

$b \circ a: 1 \xrightarrow{a} 4 \xrightarrow{b} 3$
 $2 \rightarrow 3 \rightarrow 4$
 $3 \rightarrow 2 \rightarrow 1$
 $4 \rightarrow 1 \rightarrow 2$

c. $1 \leftrightarrow 3$
 $2 \leftrightarrow 4$

$(13)(24)$

a, b, c are permutations of $\{1, 2, 3, 4\}$

$$b \circ a = c$$

Ex $G = \mathbb{Z} : 0, \pm 1, \pm 2, \pm 3, \dots$

$H : \text{even integers} \leftarrow \text{a subgroup.}$

$$H = 2\mathbb{Z}$$

multiples of 3: $3\mathbb{Z} : \dots -6, -3, 0, 3, 6, \dots$
also a subgroup.

Every subgroup of $\mathbb{Z}$ is of the form

$$n\mathbb{Z} \text{ for } n = 0, 1, 2, 3, 4, \dots$$

$\mathbb{Z} : 0, \pm 1, \pm 2, \pm 3, \dots$

even integers $\leftarrow$ a subgroup.

$$H = 2\mathbb{Z}$$

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subgroup of $\mathbb{Z}$ is of the form

for $n = 0, 1, 2, 3, 4, \dots$

Direct sums of groups

Ex $G = \mathbb{Z} : 0, \pm 1, \pm 2, \pm 3, \dots$

H : even integers $\leftarrow$ a subgroup.

$$H = 2\mathbb{Z}$$

multiples of 3: $3\mathbb{Z} = \dots, -6, -3, 0, 3, 6, \dots$
also a subgroup

Every subgroup of $\mathbb{Z}$ is of the form

$$n\mathbb{Z} \text{ for } n = 0, 1, 2, 3, 4, \dots$$

Direct sums of groups.

Let G, H be groups (comm.) w.
operations $+_G, +_H$

$$G \oplus H : (g, h) \quad g \in G, h \in H$$

$$(g_1, h_1) + (g_2, h_2) = (g_1 + g_2, h_1 + h_2)$$

$$0_{G \oplus H} = (0_G, 0_H) \text{ identity}$$

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also see:

**AlgTopReview3: More on
commutative groups**